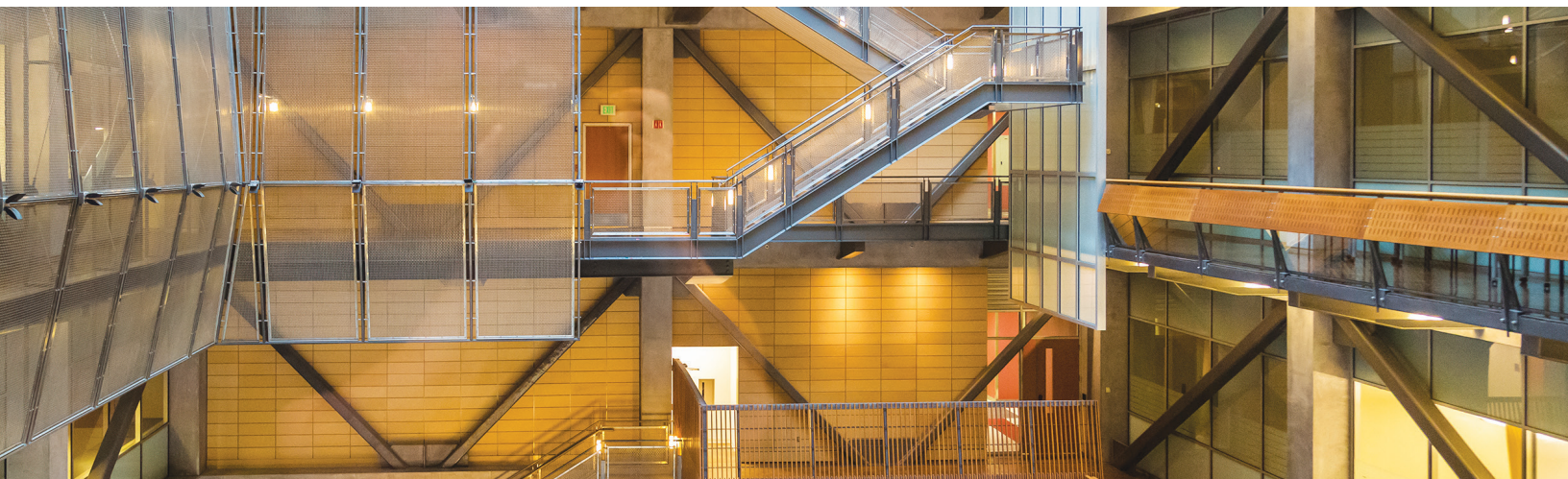


Case Study:

The Charles River Accelerator and Development Lab (CRADL™)



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PROJECT SYNOPSIS

CRADL™

BSL-2 laboratory in
Cambridge, MA

13,000 sq. ft. Turnkey
vivarium rental space

100% Innovive
disposable cages

The Charles River Accelerator and Development Lab (CRADL™) is a new animal housing and research support option from Charles River that provides turnkey vivarium rental space and technical support in highly populated research-focused regions. CRADL™ is the optimum space for clients to launch or expand their business with the added benefit of

access to Charles River's complete portfolio of integrated drug discovery resources. Managed by AALAS-certified technicians, rodents receive the best in care within secure, modern and compliant facilities. CRADL™ also supplies veterinary consultation and diagnostic services that support biosecurity efforts and ensure continued focus on animal welfare and high health standards.

The first centrally-located CRADL™ BSL-2 laboratory in Kendall Square, Cambridge, MA allows clients to invest in research projects instead of infrastructure, without compromising on the quality of workspace or equipment. It offers more than 35 animal holding rooms in a 13,000-sq. ft. space and a total cage capacity for over 31,000 mice.

Working in leased spaces, Charles River wanted to keep investment of equipment, equipment maintenance and materials to a minimum. Although the original building in Kendall Square contained a cage wash area, it was determined in early concept phases that this operation model would not utilize a cage washer for the following reasons:

- CRADL™ is a client-based service and, as such, the operations needed to be flexible enough to easily scale up or down to meet demand without having to constantly reassess the standard operating procedures (SOPs), workforce or infrastructure needs.
- Products and services must provide reliable and consistent animal care across multiple customers. Clients are concerned with sanitation practices and use of reusable caging (shared from one client's population to another client's area).
- It is important to maximize the usage of every square foot in a leased space; therefore, dedicating a large storage area to house caging is financially and spatially inefficient.
- Clients expect a space with limited need for preplanning.

The purchase, installation and on going maintenance needs of cage washing and autoclave equipment as well as chemical washing supplies and utility needs was completely avoided with the use of disposable caging.

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Due to the aforementioned concerns about using a cage washer, Charles River decided that the operation model would use the Innovive Disposable IVC Caging System. This allowed CRADL™ to avoid the purchase, installation and ongoing maintenance of cage washing and autoclave equipment, as well as chemical washing supplies and utility needs. Vivarium real estate normally dedicated to support cage washing processes could be reassigned as research space. In addition, personnel that would have supported cage cleaning are reassigned to other higher skilled animal care tasks or research support.

Space savings: Each standard animal holding room and procedure room is available to be used by one or multiple clients, i.e., dedicated or shared. With the elimination of a cage wash area, eight animal rooms and two procedure rooms were added. This model allows for more efficient space utilization and labor savings. There is no need for full-time cage wash personnel or facilities mechanical maintenance person. There is also a reduction in expenditure for chemicals and other materials needed to support the space.

Flexibility: Storage space in a leased space is wasteful; however, with regular delivery of materials, storage space needs were minimal and space is used effectively. Innovive's caging delivery provides the flexibility to scale up the number of materials on a weekly basis. Conversely, flexibility to adjust materials at a minimal notice is critical to the operation as researchers may quickly begin or exit their leased space. This efficient use of space contributes to cost containment which flows through in value to the client leasing the space. We believe this nimble flexibility contributes to a quick project start-up and will contribute to repeat or referral business.

Animal welfare: The Innovive Research-Ready™ cages reduced setup time and labor needs by arriving sterile, prepared with bedding, enrichment, and pre-filled sterile water bottles. The single-use nature of the cages improves study outcomes by promoting animal welfare and minimizing the risk for cross-contamination between animals. The pre-inserted environmental enrichment also contributes to healthy animals, which in turn optimizes research. Streamlined SOPs are in place outlining a minimum 14-day cage change (for four to five animals per cage).

Employee welfare: Charles River has been able to reduce employee risk of repetitive motion disorders by eliminating the need to manually add bedding and enrichment to cages, fill bottles with water, scrape soiled cages, as well as handle individual components in the soiled cage wash and clean cage wash areas. Reducing repetitive motion activities from the workplace demonstrates an employer's interest in creating a healthier ergonomic workplace.

The caging is not only good for the animals from a biosecurity perspective; the prepared materials that are delivered improve worker occupational health. Reduction of repetitive motion activities is a significant step in reducing worker injury and employer occupational injury-related costs.

Cost savings: The one-time startup capital investment for the purchase of caging materials and cage wash equipment was avoided. There was no need for full-time cage wash personnel thus, labor is better utilized serving clients and caring for animals.

Conclusion

The Charles River Insourcing Solutions™ team takes great pride in providing exceptional animal care services. Being able to depend on clear views of animals from unclouded cages as well as the biosecurity of disposable caging made Innovive caging the best choice for Charles River Insourcing Solution's new business model.

